Japan Portfolio Brief — Monday, October 26, 2026

Covers the weekend since Friday Oct 23 and the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Mon Oct 26. Positions treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (same as the Oct 23 run):*** *page fetches failed in the research environment (DNS errors on Kabutan, Kabuyoho, Monex), so almost everything below comes from search-result summaries. Market-level numbers are reasonably sourced;* ***no company-specific news dated Oct 23–26 was found for any single name****. "QUIET" means "searched, nothing found," not "confirmed quiet" — check TDnet/DART/KIND before acting on a single-name call. Every earnings date below is from an aggregator, not company IR, unless stated.*

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1. Top of the stack

The AI-spending sell-off is now a third straight down session for the Nikkei, with the damage concentrated in semiconductors. The Nikkei 225 closed at **62,189.65 (−503.51, −0.8%)**, its third consecutive decline, while TOPIX rose 7.17 to 3,972.98 — a rotation out of chips, with Advantest and Tokyo Electron together taking roughly 449 points off the index (Jiji, Zaikei, Business Today/Reuters). The index is about 14% below its June 25 record of 72,366 (record from the Oct 23 brief). The driver is unchanged: US AI-return doubts after Meta's spending surge and Lam Research's weak guidance, with CDS spreads on Nvidia, Oracle and Meta widening and the S&P 500 down a second straight week (MarketScreener, CNBC). Index-level read-through for the book: SoftBank, Sanken, RS Technologies, MegaChips, Keyence and Omron are the AI/semiconductor-sensitive names.

Korea sold off harder: KOSPI −1.46% to 5,469.47 (below 5,500) and KOSDAQ −3.26% to 727.21 on foreign selling, oil strength from renewed Middle East tension, and caution ahead of chip earnings and the Fed (Asia Business Daily — KOSPI, KOSDAQ, Korea Times). Foreign net-selling figures conflict (₩697bn vs ₩6.96tn) — unresolved. The KOSDAQ names in the book (Daewon Sanup, Ubiquoss) are the exposed ones.

This week is dense: SK hynix Q3 Wed Oct 28, Fed Oct 28, Samsung Electronics Oct 29, Keyence ~Oct 29, BoJ decision Fri Oct 30. SK hynix is expected to report ~₩98.2tn revenue and ~₩77.0tn operating profit (~78% margin; HBM4 for Nvidia Vera Rubin; strong won a headwind), Samsung Electronics the day after (FN News, SBS Biz). Dates are from press reports, not confirmed on IR. For the book this is the read-through to SK Inc (034730), SK Square-adjacent names, Samsung C&T and the Korean tech tape.

BoJ: a hold is the base case on Oct 30, with December the hike month. Policy rate 1.25% after the 7–2 September hike (Asada and Sato dissenting). A Reuters poll (Oct 13–19) found 54 of 78 economists expect 1.50% this quarter, ~80% of those naming a month said December and only 2% October (Investing.com/Reuters); a Bloomberg survey has 83% on December (Seoul Economic Daily). The meeting will also discuss rewording the "underlying inflation nearing 2%" language (InvestingLive). No Ueda/Takaichi/Katayama comments dated Oct 24–26 were found.

Your JGB position matures in five days — decision still needed. See Section 4. The issue is now probably identified as **JGB No. 466 (2-year, 0.50%, maturing 2026/11/01)**, inferred from the "0466" in the ISIN and an exchange price table (NSE statistics PDF) — still not confirmed against MOF terms.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **JGB yields:** I could not find Oct 26 yields. Last run's levels (Oct 23): 2y ~1.87%, 5y ~2.22%, 10y ~2.79%, 30y ~3.84%, with the 10-year having fallen ~8bp on Friday's haven demand (Trading Economics, rallies.ai). Treat as stale by one session.
- **Yen:** USDJPY on Oct 26 not found. One undated report cited ~164/USD (IDN Financials); that conflicts with ~156.1 on Oct 23 and I disregard it as stale/misdated. Finance Minister Katayama's intervention warning (Oct 15) stands.

- **Fed:** FOMC decision Oct 28 (date from earlier run); previews expect no October move, December hike possible, PCE a risk (FXEmpire). One result names Warsh as chair — unverified.
- **Tariffs:** nothing new found for October; last confirmed reaffirmation of the 15% framework and $550bn pledge is March (METI).
- **Commodities:** LME copper ~$14,242/t early Monday (−0.56%; Friday cash $14,415; −1.2% on the week; LME stocks highest since July); nickel −1.2% on the day, ~$15,700 (Mining.com, Westmetall). Mildly negative for Sumitomo Metal Mining and Mitsubishi Materials.
- **Bank of Korea:** rate 3.00% after the July and Aug 27 hikes; **BoK held 3.00% (7–0) on Oct 22 per last run's sources** (Seoul Economic Daily); next meeting Nov 26. This run's macro agent could not find the October decision and cited Governor Shin Hyun-song (name from FN News, not re-verified). KRW level not found.
- **Korea structure:** Commercial Act amendment (treasury shares cancelled within a year) passed Feb 25 (Hankyung); nothing new this weekend.

Megacaps & tech

SoftBank Group (9984) — MATTERS, with a data conflict. One report has it closing at ¥4,263 (−¥13) on Oct 26, a ~10.5-point Nikkei drag (Zaikei). That sits next to an Oct 1 close of ¥6,701 (Traders Web), implying a ~36% fall in 3.5 weeks, which is consistent with the −9.4% (Oct 15) and −5.6% (Oct 22) moves reported last run but is large enough that you should verify the level on a live quote. Funding: on Oct 1 SBG completed the third $10bn tranche of its $30bn OpenAI follow-on (funded by $11.1bn of bonds issued Sep 24), taking cumulative OpenAI investment to ~$64.6bn for ~13% (SoftBank release, Jul 1 tranche; the October release itself was not retrieved). No weekend or margin-loan news found. Q2 FY results typically early–mid November.

Keyence (6861): results expected Oct 29 per Kabuyoho (Kabuyoho); last year's was also Oct 29 (Monex). Expectations are high after the Q1 beat into a tape punishing AI-adjacent names. **Canon (7751):** Q3 date not on Canon's IR calendar page; Oct 27 is an inference from last year (Monex); Q2 OP +35.2% to ¥159.2bn with the full-year forecast raised (Canon). **Seiko Epson and Daikin:** both Nov 5 (aggregator). **MegaChips:** Nov 6. **Omron:** likely early November (Nov 7 last year). **Kubota:** early November. **Sony (6758):** no news, date unconfirmed (the Aug ¥500bn buyback continues). **NAVER (035420):** Q3 shown as Nov 11 (a self-described AI-generated calendar — unconfirmed); Dunamu/Naver Financial merger review at KFTC ongoing, nothing new. **Appier, Optex, RS Technologies, Sanken:** mid-November prints likely; Sanken's JCR outlook is negative (JCR). **SHIFT (3697):** FY Aug-2026 results may not yet be out (last year Oct 14) — check TDnet. **Oro:** Nov 16.

Banks & financials

Nothing company-specific found. Sector read: a hold on Oct 30 with December-hike pricing near-fully in supports megabank/regional NIMs; the AI sell-off is the sentiment drag; real-estate and rail names are the rate-hike losers.

- **SBI Holdings (8473):** H1 results **Nov 2** (aggregator) — the only bank/financial catalyst inside two weeks; Q1 pretax profit ¥225.8bn (+149.9%) (SBI); price ¥3,070 on Oct 16.
- **JR Central (9022):** H1 results **Oct 28** per Kabutan (Kabuyoho only says "late October") (Kabutan). **Keisei (9009):** "late October," no day (Kabuyoho). **Mitsui Fudosan (8801):** Nov 6 (guide ¥315bn vs consensus ~¥325.8bn). **TOC (8841):** early/mid November, unconfirmed.
- **Resona** Nov 10; **Kita-Nippon (8551)** Nov 12; **MUFG, Japan Post, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Yakult** Nov 13 (all Kabuyoho); **SMTG (8309):** date not found (FY3/27 net profit guide ¥380bn; post-split pricing confirmed by chart drop ~~¥6,800→~~¥1,600).
- **Fidea (8713):** Hokuto/Shonai merger into "Fidea Bank" still slated for January 2027, no delay reported; JCR affirmed BBB+ stable on Aug 24 (JCR). Exact effective date not found.
- **Shochiku (9601):** H1 already reported Oct 14 — ordinary profit ¥3.73bn vs ¥4.36bn a year ago (Monex is the Q1 item). Last run's 82% net-profit drop (impairments) is consistent. **Tokyotokeiba (9672):** Q3 early November, date not found.

Industrials, autos, materials

No company-specific news found for any name. Dated catalysts (all aggregator): Nakayama Steel and KH Neochem **Nov 5**; Suzuki and Sumitomo Metal Mining **Nov 10**; Shibaura Machine and Tigers Polymer **Nov 11**; JAPEX mid-November (Nov 13 last year). Honda, Subaru, Mitsubishi Materials, Valqua, Fudo Tetra, Ebara Jitsugyo, Obara, Katakura, Universal Entertainment: dates not found (Honda/Subaru typically early November). Hi-Lex: fiscal calendar unclear in sources. Status notes:

- **Honda:** FY3/27 OP guide ¥650bn (raised in August on the weak yen); next-gen "Honda Hybrid" from 2027 (Nikkan). A stronger yen is the swing factor.
- **Subaru:** last items are July–August (541k-SUV recall, buyback up to ¥150bn, in-house EV delayed to 2028+). Weak production trend.
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining:** ¥8,759 on Oct 19; year range ¥6,552–13,300; metals drift lower Monday.
- **Nakayama Steel:** FY guide ordinary profit ¥2.0bn (−58%), Q1 ¥610m = 30.5% of guide. **Shibaura Machine:** guide ¥3.1bn vs consensus ¥3.8bn; Q1 ordinary loss ¥261m. **Tigers Polymer:** guide ¥3.3bn (−5%). **KH Neochem:** H1 ordinary ¥7.45bn, full-year guide ¥12.6bn held. **Mitsubishi Materials:** company guide ¥180bn vs consensus ¥152.8bn.
- **JAPEX:** FY3/26 net profit ¥53.4bn (−34%); Fundare acquisition status from last run unchanged.
- **Universal Entertainment:** no October news; H1 profit already far above guide (last run), so an upward revision remains plausible but unannounced.

Korea names

Nothing company-specific dated Oct 23–26 found. Key items:

- **Taekwang Industrial (003240) — MATTERS (ongoing fight):** Trustone (5.04%) demanded board/committee minutes on Oct 13 and urged an audit-committee audit (MTN); Taekwang filed a police complaint against Trustone's CEOs on Sep 14 (MTN). Trustone had threatened a books inspection, derivative suit and EGM call (Nate); no EGM call confirmed. The value-up plan earmarks 271,769 treasury shares (24.4%) for M&A swaps, to the 2027 AGM (MTN). No PRS item found. Q3 likely ~Nov 14.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575):** Q3 prelim (Oct 7) revenue ₩23.83tn (+8.9%), OP ₩781.8bn (+13.5% y/y, −50.5% q/q) (LG); the call date is unconfirmed (late October). **LG Chem pref (051915):** Q3 weak — a Samsung Securities summary is internally inconsistent (a ₩17.5bn forecast against a ₩537.1bn consensus; last run cited ~₩9.9bn consensus) with naphtha inventory losses and a target cut to ₩380,000 (StockHub) — treat the level as unresolved, the direction (negative) as consistent.
- **Samsung C&T (028260):** one aggregator lists Q3 as Oct 22 (blank actuals), last year's was Oct 28 — date unresolved again; check DART. **SK Inc (034730):** Hana target ₩770,000 (Aug); Q3 early November. **SK Discovery (006120):** ₩62,200 intraday on Oct 20 (−6%) with no cause found.
- **Amorepacific Group (002790):** note the previews found cover Amorepacific Corp (090430), not the holding company — LS Securities Q3 OP ₩111bn (+21%) vs SK Securities ₩108.4bn (7.4% below consensus; China ~−9%) (Insight, SAT Economy).
- **Daewon Sanup (005710):** the Aug 27 court rejection of Samsung Securities/VIP Asset's board-minutes application was procedural (minutes did not exist), not a ruling on related-party deals; largest holder group 62.95% (Daily Brief). Appeal status unknown.
- **Misto (081660):** Q3 ~Nov 12 (estimate). **Motonic:** Q2 OP ₩5.8bn (+50%); **Ubiquoss:** Q2 OP ₩10.6bn (+34.5%); Q3 for both mid-November (inference).
- Quiet / nothing found: Hyosung, ILJIN, LS Corp, LG Corp, F&F, Eusu, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang.

3. Probably noise

- **TradingView headline "Nikkei 62,521 (−0.28%)"** — stale/intraday; the Jiji close of 62,189.65 is authoritative.
- **USDJPY ~164 from an undated article** — conflicts with ~156 last week; ignore until a dated quote appears.

- **Conflicting Korean foreign-flow numbers** (₩697bn vs ₩6.96tn) — direction (net selling) is the signal, not the size.
- **SK Discovery's −6% on Oct 20** — quote-page data with no catalyst found.
- **Aggregator earnings dates** (especially AI-generated calendars like knowingasset) — verify on IR/DART before calendaring.
- **Amorepacific Corp (090430) previews** — not the holding company in the book.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB JP1024661QB1 — decision needed this week. Probably JGB No. 466 (2-year, 0.50%, maturing 2026-11-01) — inferred, not MOF-verified. Nov 1 is a Sunday; redemption most likely settles **Mon Nov 2** (standard practice, unverified — confirm with the custodian); Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3 (Culture Day). Reinvestment candidates (Oct 23 levels, not refreshed): 2y ~1.87%, 5y ~2.22%, 10y ~2.79% vs the 0.50% coupon. The BoJ decision on Oct 30 (hold expected, December hike ~80% priced) is the key input; decide before Oct 30 whether to pre-position or wait. `watchlist-japan.md` retains the line pending confirmed redemption.

Calendar (dates marked * are aggregator-only/unconfirmed):

- Oct 27: Canon Q3*
- Oct 28: FOMC decision; SK hynix Q3; JR Central H1*
- Oct 29: Keyence H1*; Samsung Electronics Q3; BoJ meeting day 1 (Oct 29–30)
- Oct 30: **BoJ decision** (~12:00 JST) + outlook report; Keisei H1*
- Nov 2: SBI H1*; JGB redemption/settlement (expected)
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed
- Nov 5: Seiko Epson*, Daikin*, Nakayama Steel*, KH Neochem*
- Nov 6: MegaChips*, Mitsui Fudosan*; US October jobs report
- Nov 10–13: Suzuki*, SMM*, Resona* (Nov 10); Shibaura*, Tigers Polymer* (Nov 11); NAVER* (Nov 11); Kita-Nippon*, Misto* (Nov 12); MUFG, Japan Post, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Yakult* (Nov 13)
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea

Undated-but-live: SoftBank price/margin-loan/OpenAI funding; Taekwang–Trustone (EGM call, books-inspection suit, treasury-share cancellation under the new rules); Universal Entertainment guidance revision; LG Electronics earnings call; Daewon Sanup litigation; yen intervention risk if USDJPY approaches 160; Sanken/Allegro overhang.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for owner.** 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank (Iwate). This run's bank agent found 8524 listed on Matsui as 北洋銀行 (Hokuyo Bank, Hokkaido; FY3/26 ordinary profit ¥37.5bn, +33.7% — JPX), which is consistent with "North Pacific Bank" being its English name (that English-name mapping is from general knowledge, not a fetched source). Coverage continues on 8551; please confirm which bank is held.
2. **JGB:** likely issue No. 466 — recorded in `watchlist-japan.md` as "probable," still unverified vs MOF.
3. No other identity changes confirmed; Valqua, Fudo Tetra, Ebara Jitsugyo, Obara and Katakura were not productively searched this run (status unknown, listed QUIET).
4. Amorepacific Group (002790) vs Amorepacific Corp (090430): news searches tend to return the operating company — don't confuse.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm issue No. 466 and the redemption/settlement date with MOF/custodian; reinvestment plan relative to the Oct 30 BoJ outcome?

- **SoftBank (9984):** verify the live price (¥4,263 vs the Oct 1 ¥6,701), the cause of the decline since Oct 1, and any margin-loan/collateral triggers.
- **Keyence / Canon:** confirm Oct 29 / Oct 27 on IR; how much of Keyence's Q1 beat is priced after the semis rotation?
- **Semis read-through:** what do SK hynix (Oct 28) and Samsung (Oct 29) imply for SK Inc, Samsung C&T and the Japan equipment names (Advantest/TEL are not in the book, but they drive the Nikkei)?
- **Banks:** what are the confirmed H1 dates for SMTG and Fidea, and how much of the December hike is in bank multiples?
- **Fidea (8713) / Kita-Nippon (8551):** exact Fidea Bank effective date; resolve with the owner which bank is held (8551 vs 8524).
- **Samsung C&T (028260):** did Q3 print Oct 22, or does it print this week?
- **Taekwang (003240):** any DART filing for an EGM call, an inspection suit, or treasury-share cancellation?
- **LG Chem pref (051915):** what is the actual Q3 consensus (~~₩~~10bn vs ~~₩~~537bn in conflicting sources)?
- **Hi-Lex (7279) / Valqua / Fudo Tetra / Ebara Jitsugyo / Obara / Katakura:** retry single-name searches and confirm fiscal calendars.
- **Korea:** did the BoK hold on Oct 22, and who is the governor — the sources in the two runs conflict on detail.